

- ◆ Retailers can increase their operating margins by 60 per cent if they leverage the power of Big Data, while Fortune 1000 companies can get an additional 65 million and above income if they increase their data accessibility by 10 per cent.
- ◆ At the moment, of all the data being generated, only a minor fraction of it is analysed. Which means that there is a massive potential for what can be achieved when we achieve a state where most of the data is analysed.

The above are just a few facts when compared the enormous impact that Big Data can have on the whole for the human civilisation.

Issues of a different kind

Big Data from a technological perspective is a clear winner. However, when it comes to human civilisation, there are several other aspects to consider:

- ◆ **Legal:** The issues that could arise here would be related to intellectual property rights, privacy risk, data protection, licensing, contract, etc. The legal framework will have to catch up with technology if the power of Big Data is to be used to its full potential.
- ◆ **Social and ethical:** Unintended use of secondary data, re-use, transparency, profiling, tracking, can raise ethical issues as Big Data deals with human data on a large volume which could be an issue with social and moral codes.

The list of issues will keep on rising as this is a disruptive technology which will bring about a vast change and hence there is bound to be friction somewhere.

A few examples of Big Data usage

Improving business targeting: The most obvious place that Big Data is being used is in targeting the right customers by understanding their behaviour and preferences.

- ◆ **Making business process more efficient and optimised:** Companies that use Big Data are better able to optimise their product and its stock by analysing trends revealed by Big Data.
- ◆ **Quantified Self:** Quantifying personal data through sensors and trackers eventually leads to the formation of a pattern which can be revealed through Big Data. This can be used to improve lifestyle and/or performance.
- ◆ **Medical field:** Big Data systems can analyse DNA in a matter of minutes. When Big Data systems go through vast amounts of medical data, they